

tive personnel, including the police, have been relocated along ethnic lines, reinforcing the geographical and communal split. Along the border separating these fractured territories, village defence forces have erected bunkers, manned by young men outfitted with make-shift weaponry, walkie-talkies, bulletproof vests and binoculars. The stretch of no-man's land between these enclaves is patrolled by central forces such as the Assam Rifles and the Indian Reserve Battalion (IRB). What's most unsettling is that this breakdown has occurred

5 REASONS WHY MANIPUR IS STILL BURNING

1. The **violence between the Kuki-Zos and Meiteis** has escalated, with weaponised drones and grenades allegedly being used. The bitter rivalry has only deepened with time

2. **CM N. Biren Singh is being blamed for failing to restore order** and for being a divisive Meitei figure. His continued leadership, despite calls for his removal, has contributed to the inability to quell the unrest

3. **The BJP-led Union government has remained indifferent to the crisis,** despite the security apparatus being directly under its control. The lack of decisive intervention, including failure to impose President's Rule or replace the CM, has allowed the violence to flare up

4. The **strained ties between the state and central security forces,** particularly the Assam Rifles, has complicated efforts to control the violence. Allegations of bias and inadequate coordination between the two forces have fuelled the mistrust

5. The **spread of misinformation,** coupled with allegations that some state and non-state actors are manipulating the violence for political gain, has intensified communal tensions



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